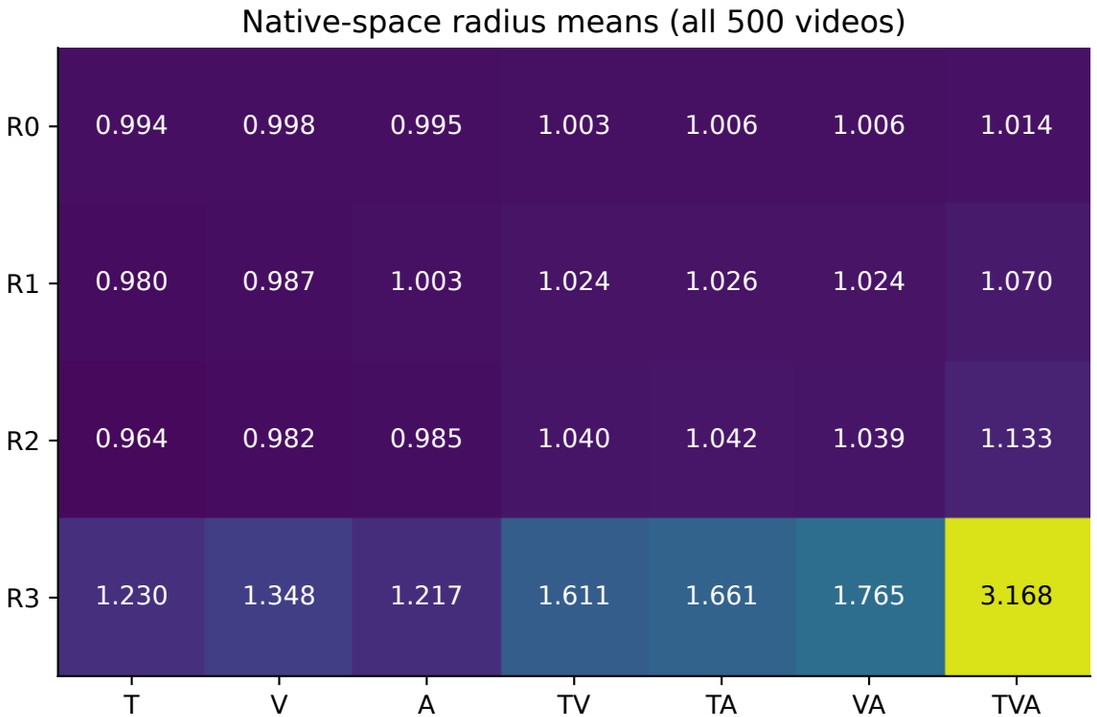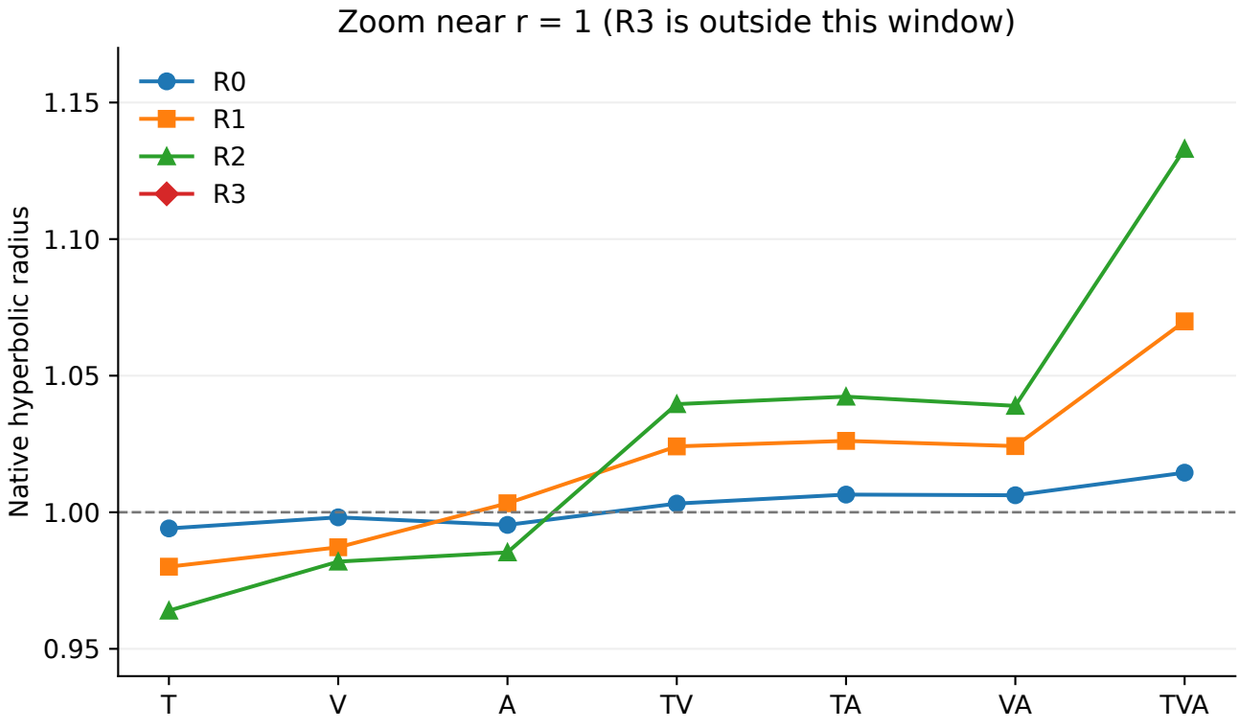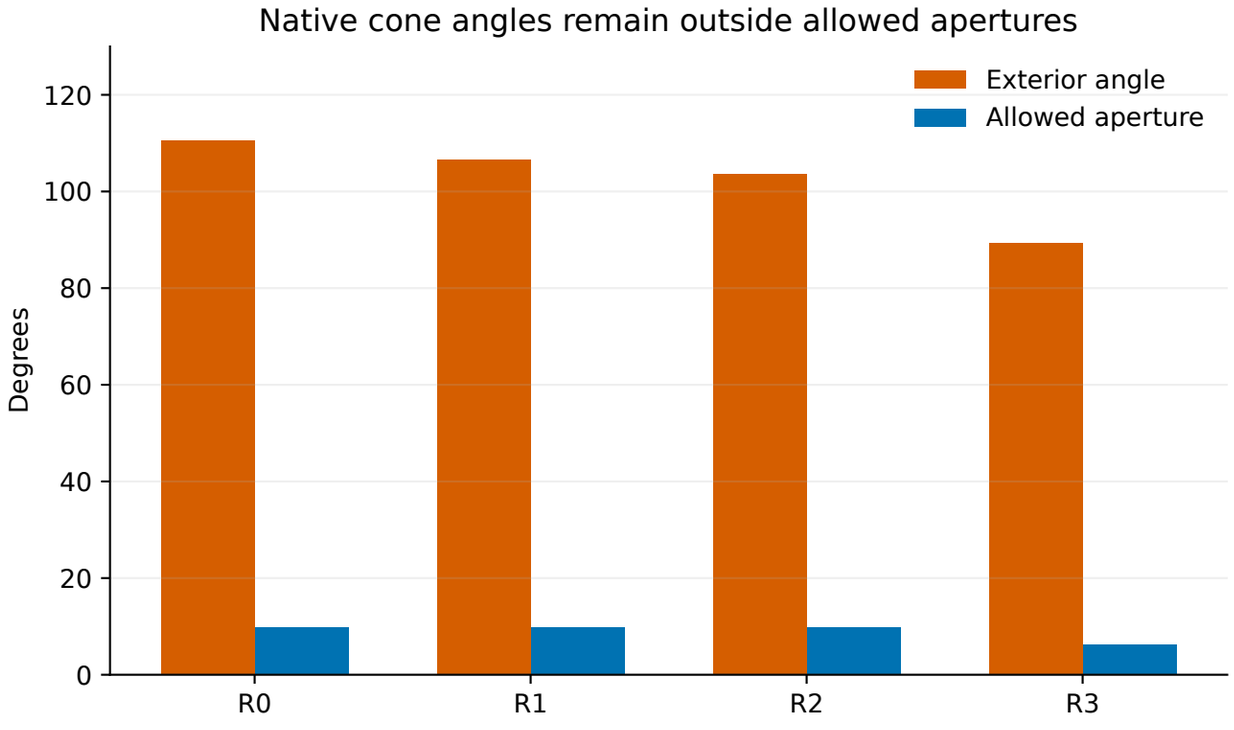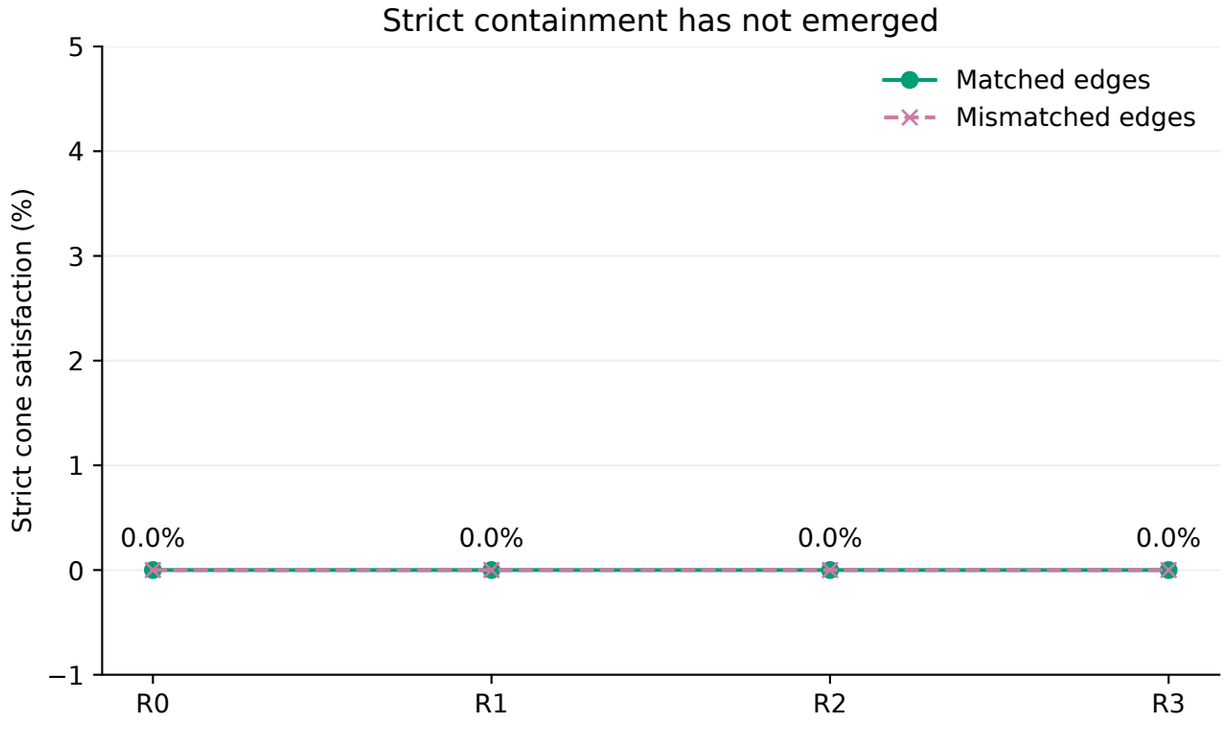Native geometry — same validation cohort and retrieval-selected checkpoints